

Notice ID

CIC5 – Persistent Cyber Training Environment (PCTE) Collaboration Event Related Notice

Department/Ind. Agency

DEPT OF DEFENSE

Sub-tier

Department of the Army

Office

Army Contracting Command

General Information

- Contract Opportunity Type: Special Notice (Original)
- All Dates/Times are: (UTC-05:00) EASTERN STANDARD TIME, NEW YORK, USA
- Original Published Date: April 29, 2025 pm EDT
- Original Response Date: May 28, 11:59 pm EDT
- Inactive Policy: 1 day after the response date
- Original Inactive Date: May 28, 2025
- Initiative:

Classification

- Original Set Aside: N/A
- Classification Code: D -- Information Technology services, including telecommunications services NAICS Code: 541 -- Professional, Scientific, and Technical Services/541330 -- Engineering Services
- Place of Performance: Augusta, GA USA

Persistent Cyber Training Environment (PCTE) - Cyber Innovation Challenge (CIC) 5 Collaboration Event (CE)

04 June 2025

Request to Attend

28 May 2025

11:59 PM ET

U.S. Citizens Only

Purpose

The Cyber Fusion Innovation Center (CFIC) and the Technology and Innovation Center (ArCTIC), in collaboration with the Program Executive Office - Simulation, Training and Instrumentation (PEO-STRI) is in search of industry expertise to maintain the operational readiness of the cyberspace workforce through the creation of a Persistent Cyber Training Environment (PCTE) - Cyber Innovation Challenge (CIC) 5. This release documents the methodology for pursuing, selecting, and assessing such solutions.

Background/Synopsis

The Department of Defense (DOD) requires a Persistent Cyber Training Environment (PCTE) - Cyber Innovation Challenge (CIC) 5 - for the 8000+ person Cyber Mission Force (CMF) to maintain operational readiness of the cyberspace workforce. A Joint PCTE mirrors the function of a physical training range used for land, air, and maritime forces, but is designed for cyberspace workforces. It operates continuously and is geographically distributed. The PCTE platform needs to evolve by leveraging emerging technologies to assist in performing human-centric tasks, with minimal human intervention, considering all aspects of the platform. Applications of these technologies should

streamline routine tasks, reducing processing time and increasing productivity. Additionally, it should enhance current capabilities and provide new insights into platform performance. Because of this, the PCTE program is seeking to improve the current training platform and introduce Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning (AI/ML), advanced automation, and/or data analysis tool solutions with the following capabilities.

Key Thoughts and Capabilities

The Collaboration Event is an innovative brainstorming session to help define a more specific problem statement, identify limiting or additional factors for consideration, and gives attendees the opportunity to work together on providing thoughts and feedback. Below are the initial three (3) identified key thoughts and capabilities, but this is in no way a complete list. The CE gives attendees a forum to bring their expertise to the table and provide invaluable knowledge for PEO-STRI to better understand any and all possibilities so they can craft a Request for Proposal (RFP) before seeking whitepaper solutions.

1. Intelligent Help Desk Support/Documentation Chatbot: PCTE requires a capability to improve processes for supporting the user in ease-of-use of the platform and leverage emerging technologies to enhance supporting the end user.
2. Range Deployment: PCTE requires a capability to automate the creation of network ranges to enable simpler deployment.
3. Predictive Resource Utilization/Advanced Range Quality of Service: PCTE requires a capability to forecast resource allocation to optimize platform efficiency and identify areas of concern.
4. Advanced User/Traffic Emulation: PCTE requires a capability to simulate user interactions to optimize platform realism in a range environment.

What is a Collaboration Event (CE)?

PEO-STRI submits specific problems to solve and CFIC utilizes its ecosystem and market research to attract best-of-breed submissions to solve the problem. The Assessors and Stakeholders from PEO-STRI subsequently review and select participants with the highest value to present and/or demonstrate their capability in a one-on-one session.

Why You Should Participate

PEO-STRI seeks to enter into non-FAR or FAR-based agreements with Industry, Academic, and National Lab partners whose solutions are favorably evaluated by Assessors, Stakeholders, and Subject Matter Experts. As such, these events are considered competitive in the same manner as a Broad Agency Announcement (BAA) or Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO), and solutions will be evaluated independently of one another primarily for technical merit.

Event Timeline

Phase 1: 04 June 2025 – Collaboration Event (IN-PERSON EVENT)

Industry, academia, and government partners will meet in-person to identify current limitations and ideate ways to overcome limiting factors. Problem statement(s) will be developed in relation to a

Persistent Cyber Training Environment (PCTE) and the previously mentioned Key Thoughts and Capabilities. Participation in this event is not mandatory. However, it is designed to provide insights to ensure a clear understanding of the problem set(s) and to match requirements that align with Warfighter needs. Other outcomes must include a clear prototype-to-production transition plan with aligned funding in which industry can compete on prototyping contracts.

Request to attend by 28 May 2025.

A link is included in the How You Can Participate section below.

Tentative CE Agenda*

0730 – 0800: Guests Arrive in lobby for check-in and visitor badges
0800 – 0810: CFIC Welcome & Housekeeping Guidance
0810 – 0855: Stakeholder Welcome; Problem Set Overview and Q&A
0855 – 0910: Limiting Factors Breakout Session Instructions
0910 – 0920: Break – Attendees randomly assigned to 1st team upon return
0920 – 1015: Limiting Factors Breakout Sessions
 0920 – 0945: Current Limitations Round 1
 0945 – 0950: Attendees switch to 2nd team
 0950 – 1015: Current Limitations Round 2
1015 – 1035: Break & Collate
1035 – 1135: Future Needs (Overcoming Limiting Factors) – move to 3rd team
1135 – 1300: Lunch Break (On Your Own) – Walkable Lunches list in notebook
1300 – 1305: Problem Statement Development & Solution Briefs Instructions
1305 – 1405: Problem Statement Development & Solutions Briefs Breakout Session
1405 – 1420: Break
1420 – 1700: Problem Statement Briefs Presentations
1700 – 1720: Voting Instructions, Voting, and Wrap-Up
1720 – 1730: Follow-On Schedule and Thanks

*Agenda is subject to change

This event will be held in person at CFIC – 200 Grace Hopper Lane, Building 2, 5th Floor, Augusta, GA.

Phase 2: Whitepaper Submissions Open**

The resulting problem statement from the Collaboration Event will be crafted into a Request for Proposal and distributed via the sam.gov website and Vulcan submission portal to receive whitepapers/responses. The whitepaper submission window will open and accept whitepaper documents for approximately 30 days.

Phase 3: Grading and Down-selects**

The Assessment Team will work through submissions using their pre-determined assessment criteria for grading and making down-selects of those respondents/submissions they feel have the highest potential to satisfy their needs. Favorably evaluated submissions will receive an invitation to

attend Phase 4. Grading and down-selecting will take place in the Vulcan system and be led by the Assessment Team. This timeframe is approximately 10-14 days.

Phase 4: Assessment Event (AE)**

After down-selects are chosen, there will be about 14-21 days when the selected companies are notified and then those companies can prepare their prototype demonstrations for the Assessment Team.

During the AE, selected participants will be allotted a one-on-one session with the ARCYBER evaluation panel to pitch, demonstrate, and/or discuss their solutions.

Phase 5: Follow-On**

The Government has several acquisition/contract vehicles (i.e., various IDIQ contracts, purchase orders, etc.) to potentially purchase the final system if operationally viable. The Government may elect to purchase all, some, and/or none of the solutions from Phase 4 for further projects.

*** The timeframe is TBD based on the results of the CE, creation / publish of a Request for Proposal (RFP), and needs of the Assessment Team and Stakeholders.*

How You Can Participate

RSVP to the 04 June 2025 Collaboration Event – [CLICK HERE](#)

Questions?

For event-related questions, please contact CFIC Event Coordinator Amanda Green at agreen@cyberfic.org.

DISCLAIMERS:

An award under 10 U. S. Code, Section 2371b may result in award of a follow-on production in accordance with 10.U.S.C. 2371(f). Upon determination that the competitively awarded prototype project(s) have been successfully completed, and subject to the availability of funds, the prototype project(s) may result in the award of a follow-on production contract or transaction without the use of competitive procedures. Such awards may include multiple phases.

Non-Government advisors may be used in the evaluation of submissions and will have signed Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDAs) with the Government. The Government understands the information provided in this announcement is presented in confidence and may contain trade secret or commercial or financial information and agrees to protect such information from unauthorized disclosure to the maximum extent permitted and as required by law. An organization's participation in any part of the selection process under this announcement indicates concurrence with the aforementioned use of contractor support personnel.